

1. We have no choice about what God knew in the past.
2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.
3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X, we have no choice about X.
5. God knowing that we will perform some action necessitates that we will perform that action.

C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions. (3,4,5)

THE FOREKNOWLEDGE ARGUMENT

1. We have no choice about past facts.
 - 2*. In the past, there were truths about all of our future actions.
 3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
 4. If we have no choice about p, and no choice about the fact that if p, then q, then we have no choice about q.
 - 5*. We have no choice about the fact that if it is true that I will perform some action, then I will perform that action.
-

C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions.
(3,4,5)

The fatalist argument

It is tempting to reply to
the Foreknowledge
Argument by saying that
while God does know
what we are going to do,
God does not **make** us
do anything.

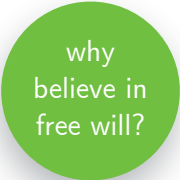
But suppose that that is true. Does that call into question any of the premises of the argument?



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out



1 We have no choice about what God knew in

overtire actiois.

3. We have not checked that

the past.

inches abut x.

God knows that in the future I will

2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of

4. If we have no choice about some facts,

and those facts need sit at X , we have

theater in air.



perform certain action. (1,2)

C. We have no choice but to wait until

5. Good knowing that we will perform some

perform future actions. (3,4,5)

action necessitates that we will perform





1. We have no advice about past facts.

God knows that in the future I will

2* In the past, there were trials about

then we have the choice about q.

3 We have not heard that

acai.oi.

performa certain action (1,2)

will perform various actions.

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

all of our activities.



0. We have introduced what we

that if it is true that I will perform

some action, then I will perform that

(3, 4, 5)

5* We have established the fact

the Foreknowledge

God does not make us

Argument by saying that

do anything.



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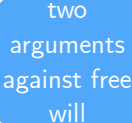
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Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.



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three
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first let's think about how Edwards'

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

We'll shortly consider some ways of

responding to Edwards' argument. But

Suppose that someone did not believe in

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

actions. Could they give an argument

similar to Edwards' argument?

there were truths about all our future

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

our future actions.

God only shows up in premises (2) and

with reference to the being of truth about

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

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The fatalist argument

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

things as fate, then there is no free will.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?



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THE FOREKNOWLEDGE ARGUMENT

knows all of the choices we

not know what decisions we

will face, and knows what

would happen if we made

various decisions, but does

freedom by saying that God

for knowledge with our



It is also tempting to try to

